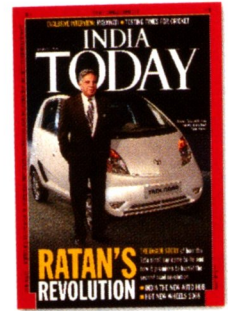


HEMANT CHAWLA



"Ratan's Revolution",
January 21, 2008

"The Nano will go down in history just as a revolutionary car like Ford's Model T and Volkswagen Beetle did. Hats off to Ratan Tata."

DURGAPRASAD S., on e-mail

No Small Feat

Anyone can build an extravagant car ("Ratan's Revolution", January 21). But to manufacture the cheapest car in the world is a feat only the great can accomplish.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

By launching the Nano, Ratan Tata has proved to the world that whatever others can do, Indians can do better. The car is going to rewrite history in the automobile industry.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

Nano is the triumph of Indian entrepreneurial intrepidity and technological creativity. But it is likely to be hit by the roadblock of poor infrastructure and spiralling petrol prices.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

As an Indian, I am proud of what Tata has achieved.

The group's policy of social welfare is worth emulating. I hope he makes lots of money through this car.

SAGAR CHATTERJEE,
on e-mail

People rushing to Pragati Maidan in Delhi to have a glimpse of the Nano is a tribute to Tata's efforts.

The cheapest car is a dream-come-true for those belonging to the lower and the middle class.

MAN MOHAN BHATIA, Delhi

Reducing affordability of motor cars before improving public transport network and ensuring environmental protection is akin to keeping the cart before the horse. It is ironic that in a country where the majority cannot even afford bus or train travel, there are many who do not pay a single paise as income tax and yet enjoy all the luxuries of life, owning a motor car being just one of them.

S.P. ASOKAN, on e-mail

The article brought two things to the forefront: the capability of Indian engineers and more importantly the social responsibility of the Tatas towards the country. They have manufactured a car that suits a large number of pockets.

ARCHANA NEGI, on e-mail

Tata kept his promise. The only danger the car is going to pose is that it will lead to traffic jams. I hope the Tatas help in solving this problem as well.

SHAILESH KUMAR, Bangalore

An Illusion Called Maya

Behind her apprehension about her safety lies Mayawati's shrewd calculation centred around votebank politics ("Elephantine Strides", January 21). Having tasted success with her brand of social engineering in Uttar Pradesh, she now wants to capture the Centre.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA
Mysore

Mayawati has no sense of propriety. Without any compunction, she speaks of cheating her rivals and seeks SPG protection merely because she is a Dalit leader. She represents everything that is vulgar and uncouth in Indian politics. One shudders to think of her as a future prime minister.

B.N. GURURAJ, Bangalore

A unique phenomenon, Mayawati belongs to that rare breed of leaders who do not depend on others around them. Her combativeness and supreme self-confidence have made her an idol all over the country, much beyond her traditional mass base.

NUTAN THAKUR, Lucknow

The enigma of Mayawati has baffled many a strategist. She has brought Brahmins and Dalits under one flag. The country direly needs leaders who can